



Li Zihao

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 [MiShenng](#)

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Education

- **Lanzhou University, Lanzhou**

Sep. 2023 -

B.A. in Journalism

- **Relevant Coursework:** New Media User Analysis, Communication Psychology, Media Criticism, Research Methods in Communication Studies, Data Journalism, Introduction to Communication Studies, Public Opinion

- **GPA:** 4.05/5.0

- **National Taiwan Normal University, Taipei**

Aug. 2025 - Dec. 2025

Exchange Student

- **Relevant Coursework:** Visual Culture and Communication, Research Method of Social Science, New Media and Society Seminar

- **GPA:** 3.9/4.0

Peer-reviewed publications & Conference Papers

- **Should I stay calm: How does the combination of visual and textual frames influence expressions of anger in short video comment sections?** *AEJMC 2026*

*Li, Zihao.**



- This study proposes an analytical method for measuring visual and textual frames in dynamic videos, which was subsequently tested on 439 short videos on Douyin related to the issue of drug addiction in China. Machine learning was then used to identify expressions of anger on a large scale in the comment sections of short video platforms covering this topic, which were used as the dependent variable in a regression analysis.
- The results indicate that visual frames take precedence in emotional framing. Different combinations of visual and textual frames correspond significantly to varying degrees of anger expression, and consistency between them influences anger expression in comment sections. Multimodal combinations better explain emotional differences in comment sections than single-modal factors.

Working Papers & Research in Progress

- **Seeing Is Clicking? How Visual and Textual Clickbait Cues in News Video Covers Shape User Engagement on Bilibili** *Under review*

*Li, Zihao.**



- Clickbait research has focused almost exclusively on textual headlines, yet for video platforms the thumbnail image—not the title—is the primary point of contact that determines whether users click. This study shifts the analytical lens from text to visuals by investigating how specific visual features of news video thumbnails drive user engagement on Bilibili. Drawing on information gap theory and visual framing, we employ computer vision techniques—including facial emotion recognition, color palette analysis, object salience detection, and visual complexity measurement—to extract and quantify visual characteristics from a large-

scale dataset of over 54320 news and current affairs video thumbnails.

- Engagement is operationalized through multiple platform-native metrics (views, likes, danmaku comments, coin-tossing, and favorites). Results reveal that distinct visual features exert divergent effects across engagement dimensions. The findings suggest that visual sensationalism in thumbnails operates through a curvilinear logic—moderate visual intensity attracts attention while excessive exaggeration triggers viewer skepticism. This study contributes a purely visual analytical framework for clickbait research and provides the first large-scale empirical evidence of how thumbnail visuals independently shape news engagement dynamics on a non-Western video platform.

Research Experience

● A Study on Discourse Construction and Visual Narrative Strategies in the New Mainstream Media Environment of the Converged Media Era Dec. 2024 - Apr. 2025

PI: Li xinxin, Lanzhou University [🌐]

Research Assistant

- Basic Research Projects of Central Universities in China
- Using reports from the People's Daily as representative examples of mainstream media, I constructed a dataset of environmental news coverage from 1949 to the present. I then developed an LLM-driven automated content analysis program to perform coding. Applying Fairclough's discourse analysis methodology and combining the coding results with the evolution of China's environmental protection policies, I broadly divided the historical development of China's environmental protection discourse into distinct phases.
- Using a self-built web crawler to collect Weibo posts related to environmental protection from the People's Daily to date, and conducted a comparative analysis of this data with content from the newspaper's print editions.

● A Study on the "Human-Machine Co-creation" Mechanism and Innovative Practices in AI-Empowered Cultural Narratives Along the Silk Road Mar. 2025 - May. 2025

PI: Li xinxin, Lanzhou University [🌐]

Research Assistant

- Compilation of narrative resources on the history of the Silk Road
- Compile the research trends in various social sciences related to the Silk Road and write a comprehensive review

● Lanzhou Bathing Assistant: Seeing Aging at Mobile Bathhouses Aug. 2024 - Jan. 2025

Advisor: Shiping, Lanzhou University [🌐]

Field Research

- Conducted ethnographic field research on the emerging in-home elder-bathing industry in Lanzhou, examining how disabled and bedridden older adults navigate bodily dignity, agency, and social invisibility under China's home-based eldercare model. Performed on-site participant observation of bathing services and semi-structured interviews with the company founder, bathing assistants, eldercare-center managers, and family caregivers.
- Situated individual narratives within China's accelerating demographic transition, analyzing structural barriers — arid climate, limited water infrastructure, and deeply rooted cultural attitudes toward death and the aging body — that impede the industry's expansion in northwest China. This resulted in an in-depth written report and a short video documentary.

● Why Do College Students Have a Particular Affinity for Life "Within the System"? —A Mechanism Analysis of College Students' Employment Behavior and Policy Recommendations Apr. 2024 - Apr. 2025

Advisor: Zhangchi, Lanzhou University [🌐]

Co Worker

- Investigated the behavioral mechanisms driving Chinese college students' intensifying preference for public-sector employment. Co-designed the survey instrument, oversaw questionnaire distribution and data collec-

tion, and performed statistical analysis to isolate key predictors of career-choice behavior.

- Complemented quantitative findings with semi-structured interviews, triangulating survey data with personal narratives to unpack the motivations fueling the civil-service-exam craze (*kaogong* fever) and to formulate evidence-based policy recommendations.

Selected Awards and Honors

• China Data Journalism Competition <i>Second Prize (National Level)</i>	<i>Nov. 2025</i>
• China Statistical Modeling Competition <i>First Prize (Provincial Level)</i>	<i>May. 2026</i>
• Central China Mathematical Modeling Competition <i>Second Prize (Provincial Level)</i>	<i>May. 2026</i>
• China University Campus Media Competition <i>Public Service Communication Award(Provinvial Level)</i>	<i>Nov. 2025</i>
• 14th China Tower Journalists’ Day <i>Grand Prize in the Communications Category(Provincial Level)</i>	<i>Dec. 2025</i>
• Lanzhou University Outstanding Student Scholarship <i>University Level</i>	<i>Sep. 2023 - Sep. 2024</i>

Skills

Programming	Python, R, Web (HTML, CSS, JavaScript), AI4SS
Analytical Tools	SPSS, NVivo
NLP/ML Models	BERT, LDA, and other transformer-based architectures
Production Tools	L ^A T _E X, Microsoft Office Suite, Photography
Language	IELTS(6.5), Cet6(530), Cet4(518), Mandarin